

COUNTRY-WISE COSTS

- Cost of treatment in several countries is steeper than what patients pay in India
- Indian hospitals typically charge international patients more than the domestic ones



Treatment	Hip replacement	Knee replacement	Heart bypass	Angioplasty	Heart valve replacement	Dental implant
 US	7.1X	8.1X	27.7X	17.3X	30.9X	2.8X
 Malaysia	1.1X	1.1X	2.2X	1.6X	1.9X	1.7X
 Singapore	1.7X	2.1X	3.6X	3.9X	2.3X	1.5X
 Thailand	1.1X	2X	2.9X	1.1X	3.9X	3.6X

SOURCE CRISIL INTELLIGENCE REPORT

around 10% of its overall revenue. “Medical value travel is an important strategic growth pillar for us, though our approach is fundamentally centred around clinical excellence rather than volume generation,” says Anas Abdul Wajid, Group Director & Chief Sales and Marketing Officer, Max Healthcare. Three factors, he says, will determine patient outflows in the future—healthcare gaps in source countries, geopolitical stability and connectivity, and institutional reputation.

“We expect the profile of international patients to become more diversified. While neighbouring countries will continue to contribute significantly, there is increasing demand from Africa, Central Asia and the Gulf for highly specialised treatments requiring multidisciplinary care,” adds Wajid.

For Apollo Hospitals, international patient services accounted for 6% of the inpatient revenue mix in FY26. “It is a meaningful strategic component. Apollo does not separately publish its profitability. Its value lies in strengthening complex-care volumes and utilisation of advanced clinical infrastructure,” says the company spokesperson.

Each player follows a different strategy based on existing strengths. Fortis’ Garg says her organisation’s approach is built on clinical differentiation (including oncology, bone marrow transplantation and robotic surgery), market diversification (to reduce dependence on any single geography) and a local market presence (through representative offices, partnerships, and collaborations with governments).

Manipal’s Rajagopal says the government deserves credit for recognising healthcare as an important export sector. This covers initiatives like e-medical visas, among other things. “But if we want to sustain double-digit growth over the next decade, we need to create an ecosystem that makes India the easiest and most trusted place in the world to seek medical care,” he adds.

UPPING THE GAME

The quality of healthcare in India has improved, especially in private hospitals, but a negative perception persists in some pockets. Much of that is attributed to agents or facilitators, an unorganised segment.

Sahil Jain, CEO & Co-Founder, The Medical Travel Company, a medical concierge platform, says the business is driven by trust and perception. “Medical tourism falls